

to be played in Australia between March 1 and 21.

One battle after another

Memory is frugal in football. The Asian Cup qualification, though historic, is past now, and India must remember that its trial by fire begins now. It will be pitted against heavyweights Japan, Vietnam and Chinese Taipei — all higher-ranked sides, with the first two having played in the previous FIFA Women’s World Cup.

India appointed Valverde earlier this year, especially because of her prior experience guiding Costa Rica to two Women’s World

India’s route to AFC Asian Cup



- vs Mongolia — **13-0**
- vs Timor-Leste — **4-0**
- vs Iraq — **5-0**
- vs Thailand — **2-1**





TEAM PROFILE

FIFA RANKING: 67
NO. OF ASIAN CUP APPEARANCES: 10
BEST FINISH: RUNNER-UP
(1980, 1983)

GROUP STAGE SCHEDULE

MARCH 4	INDIA VS VIETNAM	4:30 PM	PERTH RECTANGULAR STADIUM
MARCH 7	INDIA VS JAPAN	4:30 PM	PERTH RECTANGULAR STADIUM
MARCH 10	INDIA VS CHINESE TAIPEI	2:30 PM	WESTERN SYDNEY STADIUM, SYDNEY

INDIA SQUAD

GOALKEEPERS: PANTHOI CHANU ELANGBAM, SHREYA HODDA, SOWMIYA NARAYANASAMY

DEFENDERS: ASTAM ORAON, JULI KISHAN, MARTINA THOKCHOM, NIRMALA DEVI PHANJOUBAM, SANJU YADAV, SARITA YUMNAM, SHILKY DEVI HEMAM, SUSHMITA LEPCHA, SWEETY DEVI NGANGBAM

MIDFIELDERS: AVEKA SINGH, BABINA DEVI LISHAM, JASODA MUNDA, SANFIDA NONGRUM, SANGITA BASFORE

FORWARDS: GRACE DANGMEI, KAVIYA PAKKIRISAMY, LYNDA KOM SERTO, MALAVIKA P, MANISHA KAILYAN, PYARI XAXA, RIMPA HALDAR, SOUMYA GUGULOTH, KARISHMA SHIRVOIKAR